Ideation Phase

Define the Problem Statements

Customer Problem Statement Template:

A customer problem statement lets a team see an issue through the eyes of the people it affects. It keeps attention on what matters to them, gives everyone one shared description of the problem, and helps the team decide which ideas deserve to be built.

In this project, the statements capture how employees, approving managers and IT procurement staff experience the current process of ordering standard laptops, and the points where Flow Designer automation can step in.

Customer Problem Statements

Problem Statement (PS)	I am	I am trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	A newly hired employee who needs a standard laptop	Have a laptop ordered and delivered before my joining date	The request goes through several manual approvals and follow-ups	Requests travel by email and every step waits for someone to act	Anxious and unable to be productive in my first days
PS-2	A department manager who approves requests for my team	Approve my team's laptop requests without delay	Requests reach me with missing details and repeated reminders, even for standard models	No rule exists to pre-approve eligible roles, and budget details are missing from the request	Overloaded, and unsure whether I am approving within budget
PS-3	An IT procurement coordinator	Fulfil laptop orders correctly from stock or from vendors	I retype request details, check inventory manually and chase order status	The stages from request to delivery are not linked in one automated flow	Frustrated and stretched by repetitive work

Tip: Every statement follows one pattern: who the person is, what they want to do, what blocks them, why it happens, and how it feels. Read across a row to get one complete problem statement.

Selected Problem Statement

Problem statement for the brainstorm

PS-1, PS-2 and PS-3 share one root cause: a request that relies on manual hand-offs between people. They have been merged into a single problem statement to guide the brainstorm.

PROBLEM

How might we use Flow Designer in ServiceNow to automate standard laptop orders, so that employees get approved devices sooner and the IT team spends less time on repetitive procurement tasks?

What a good outcome looks like

- Employees request a standard laptop through a single catalog item and can follow its status.
- Eligible requests move through approval with little or no manual chasing.
- Stock checks, purchase orders and asset records are created automatically.